

Grants & Support for Veterans

Veterans get dedicated business training, certification, and funding to help them succeed as entrepreneurs. Below are trusted national resources. Tick the box once you've checked each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

Much of this support is free, and veteran certification can unlock set-aside government contracts. Beware of anyone charging big fees for "veteran business grants."

1 Free Veteran Business Training

Programs built specifically for veteran entrepreneurs.

☐ Veterans Business Outreach Centers

Free training, mentoring, and help for veterans and military spouses.

→ www.sba.gov/local-assistance/resource-partners/veterans-business-outreach-center-vboc-program

☐ Boots to Business

Free SBA entrepreneurship training for service members and spouses.

→ www.sba.gov/event/boots-business

2 Win Government Contracts

Certification opens set-aside contracts for veteran-owned firms.

☐ Veteran-Owned Small Business Certification

Free certification to compete for veteran set-aside federal contracts.

→ www.sba.gov/federal-contracting/contracting-assistance-programs/veteran-contracting-assistance-programs

3 Funding for Veterans

Loans and grants that support veteran-owned businesses.

☐ SBA Veterans Advantage Loans

SBA loans with benefits for veteran-owned businesses.

→ www.sba.gov/business-guide/grow-your-business/veteran-owned-businesses

☐ Hivers and Strivers / Veteran Funds

Angel investors and funds focused on veteran founders. Also check StreetShares Foundation grants.

→ www.sba.gov/business-guide/grow-your-business/veteran-owned-businesses

☐ CDFIs & Kiva

Flexible community loans and 0% microloans for veterans.

→ www.kiva.org/borrow

4 More Veteran Resources

Additional help built for the military community.

☐ **VA — Veteran Entrepreneur Resources**

The VA's hub linking to business support for veterans.

→ www.va.gov/careers-employment

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Veteran business grants are limited and competitive — never pay a fee to “claim” one. The free training and certification through SBA are where most veterans get the biggest real benefit.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Start with Boots to Business or a VBOC — they're free, built for veterans, and connect you to funding and contracts you may not find alone.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Need help where you live?

This guide covers national programs. For your nearest VBOC and state veteran-business benefits, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
